CHAPTER 9

E C O N O M I C A N A L Y S I S A N D T H E F U T U R E

POLITICAL UNCERTAINTIES

Some framework of general assumptions with respect to Palestine's political future is required as a basis for any attempt to outline her potentialities of economic development during the next decade. Yet no firm framework exists. The dominant articulate elements of both the Arab and Jewish peoples in Palestine aspire to sovereignty over the State. Britain has her own military and imperial interests in Palestine. At present, under such authority as the United Nations may exert, Britain's is the decisive voice. It is not yet clear what "postwar" adjustment these three lines of policy will receive, and it is not certain that the "postwar" adjustment will persist, without substantial alteration for as long as a decade.

The Palestine Arabs today demand that no further Jewish immigration into Palestine be allowed. They make this demand irrespective of the existence of opportunities for such immigration without any economic damage to themselves -- and indeed in spite of the likelihood that such immigration would continue to bring them handsome economic gains. This Arab determination to exclude additional Jews from Palestine is maintained in the face of (a) the dire need of the Jewish people, (b) the historic connection of the Jews with Palestine, (c) the international pledges with respect to the Jewish national home, and (d) the existence of several undeveloped Arab countries who are free to exclude Jews from their territories if they please. In our judgment, from a general world view which attempts an equitable evaluation of the claims of both Arabs and Jews, the political aims of the Palestine Arabs -- while not unintelligible -- are extravagant and unreasonable.

The Palestine Jews, as represented authoritatively by the Jewish Agency for Palestine, demand that they be recognized immedi-